

CURRICULUM VITA

1. PERSONAL INFORMATION

Name: Alixander Sebhatu Gebremariam			
Sex: Male	Years of experience: >10yrs	Address: Bahir-Dar	Citizen: Ethiopian
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2. PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY OR OBJECTIVE:

Since 2016, I have worked with the internationally funded REDD+ Climate Resilience Program, serving as a key technical and coordination Specialist. I have led region-wide trainings, capacity-building sessions, consultations, and stakeholder workshops, reaching over 12,900 participants. My contributions helped the program secure \$100 million for Phase II and exceed its reforestation target by restoring over 349,400 hectares. I managed geospatial databases supporting internationally recognized MRV systems and oversaw data processing critical to program monitoring. This work positioned the region to engage in international carbon trading through ARTTREE methodologies. I bring strong expertise in results-based implementation, international negotiation, and stakeholder coordination. I am committed to applying these experiences to advance your organizations environmental and climate objectives.

3. WORK EXPERIENCE

3.1 **Employer:** Amhara Regional REDD (Reforestation & Conservation) Investment Program (NGOs), Phase II

Position: Sinner Coordination Forestry & Geo-information Specialist

Supporting: Zones Head-8, and Districts-Coordination 28 and 140 Experts

Experience: From July 01, 2019 to now (for ~ 7 years)

Key Areas of Accountability and Achievements

1. Planning and Coordination

- ✓ Steered the planning, coordination, implementation and follow-ups of program activities Scale up afforestation and reforestation achieved, Assisted Natural Regeneration, participatory forest managements and livelihoods of the program major targets.
- ✓ Collaborating with national, regional, and Districts-level institutions to ensure alignment with REDD+ (Reducing emission from deforestations and forest degradations) objectives, contributing to sustainable natural resource management and climate resilience.

2. Target based Monitoring, Evaluation, and Impact Assessment

- ✓ Supporting the monitoring and evaluation of REDD+ interventions, ensuring alignment with the National determinant contributions (NDC) Strategic Framework and Climate resilience Green Economy (CRGE) and Programming Framework (CPF) priorities.
- ✓ Conducting field missions to evaluate progress, provide technical guidance, and promote improved outcomes for climate resilience and forest conservation efforts.
- ✓ Achieved that Amhara Region, under the REDD+ Investment Program, successfully developed and managed more than 349,400 hectares of forest resources. This achievement positions the region for eligibility in the carbon financing phase under result-based payment mechanisms.

3. Geo-Spatial Analysis and Mapping intervention Areas and activities

- ✓ Developed and implemented advanced geo-spatial data-based to monitor Livelihood intervention, Beneficiary, Market linkages, deforestation, forest degradation, and landuse changes in support of REDD+ initiatives.
- ✓ Delivered high-quality, detailed maps and spatial data products to guide policy decisions and project planning at national and regional levels.

4. Prepare the program for Voluntary Carbon Market (VCM) mechanism

- ✓ Developed and operationalized a National Forest Monitoring System (NFMS) to support transparent MRV of forest carbon data.
- ✓ Prepared and submitted scientifically credible Forest Reference Emission Levels (FREL/FRL), validated under UNFCCC processes.
- ✓ Implemented REDD+ strategies addressing deforestation, degradation, and carbon stock enhancement at national/subnational levels.
- ✓ Established a Safeguard Information System (SIS) to ensure compliance with environmental and social safeguards.
- ✓ Strengthened legal, institutional, and governance frameworks for carbon rights, MRV, and benefit-sharing mechanisms.
- ✓ Facilitated inclusive stakeholder engagement and FPIC processes, enabling third-party verification and carbon credit registry access.

5. Dashboard and Database Management

- ✓ Creating web-based dashboards and databases for the National Monitoring, Reporting, and Verification (MRV) Situation Room. As it is ready for carbon financing validations.
- ✓ Preparing and managing structured databases to systematically store, update, and retrieve reports, best practices, lessons learned, and documented experiences related to climate resilience activities, including pre- and post-intervention photographs and

video materials.

3.2 Employer: Amhara Regional REDD (Reforestation & Conservation) Readiness Investment Program (NGOs), Phase I

Position: Sinner Coordination Forestry officer

Supporting: Zones Head-8, and Districts-Coordination 24 and 120 Experts

Experience: From July 01, 2016 to June 30, 2019 (for ~ 4 years)

Key Areas of Accountability and Achievements

(All documented and reported)(<http://www.reddplusethiopia.wordpress.com/>)

1. Readiness Organization and Consultation

- ✓ Addressed policy, legal and institutional issues related to forest governance
- ✓ Ensured that the REDD+ is implemented according to globally acceptable social and environmental safeguards
- ✓ **Stakeholder mapping and networking:** systematically identified all relevant stakeholders (government agencies, NGOs, CSOs, private sector, local communities, indigenous peoples, donors, etc.)
- ✓ Enhanced knowledge generation and promoting public awareness, communication, and information-sharing on REDD+ initiatives to foster deeper understanding and strengthen ownership of the program among stakeholders at all levels.

2. Consultation and workshop organizations

- ✓ Ensured broad participation from government, communities, NGOs, private sector, and marginalized groups (e.g., women, indigenous peoples).
- ✓ Gathered inputs for strategy design, safeguards, benefit-sharing, and grievance redress systems.

3. Capacity buildings and trainings provisions

- ✓ Provided training on core REDD+ technical areas such as: Forest carbon measurement, MRV (Monitoring, Reporting, and Verification), GIS and remote sensing and Safeguards and benefit-sharing.
- ✓ Facilitated **inclusive training programs** for local communities, especially indigenous peoples and women, to increase awareness and ensure meaningful participation.

4. REDD+ Strategy preparation

- ✓ It was final document prepared and consulted with stakeholders. Including of
 - Conducted comprehensive assessments of land use patterns, change drivers, and the legal-policy framework governing forest management.
 - Actively contributed to the development and review of national REDD+ strategy options in alignment with international standards.

5. Reference Emissions level/Reference Level

- ✓ Actively participated as part of the Amhara Region delegation in national efforts, utilizing Collect Earth and other geospatial tools for forest data collection and analysis.
- ✓ Contributed to the technical preparation and validation of the Forest Reference Level (FRL), which was officially reviewed and published by the UNFCCC in 2017.

- ✓ As a result of the FRL assessment, Ethiopia's national net emissions were recorded at 1,501,393 tCO₂e/year, with an overall forest cover of 15.54%, and 9.8% specifically attributed to the Amhara Region.

6. Monitoring System for Forest and Safeguards

- ✓ It was 4 REDD+ safeguards instruments prepared (SESA, ESMF, RPF and PF).
- ✓ Contributed the development and operationalization of the Regionally Forest Monitoring System (NFMS), enabling accurate and transparent forest data reporting aligned with UNFCCC requirements.
- ✓ Designed and contributed to the implementation of an integrated information system capturing multiple benefits, governance indicators, safeguards, and socio-environmental impacts of REDD+ activities.

3.3 Employer: Forest Enterprise and tree seed Center (Governmental organization)

Position: Sinner forestry Expert

Supporting: Zones Head 8, and 90 Experts

Experience: From October 24, 2011 to June 30, 2016 (for ~ 5.6 years)

Key areas of accountability and accomplishments

1. Community-Based Forestry and Enterprise Development

- ✓ Established and strengthened cooperatives, user groups, and community organizations to promote sustainable forestry enterprises.
- ✓ Provide technical and business development support to smallholder farmers, youth, and women engaged in forestry-related ventures.
- ✓ Facilitated access to financial resources, training programs, and market linkages for forest products and tree seeds.
- ✓ Promoted value-added processing to enhance product quality and economic returns.

2. Tree Seed Center Development and Management

- ✓ Established the first Regional Tree Seed Centers to provide tested and quality-assured tree seeds.
- ✓ Selected 75 predominant tree seed sources based on phenotypic and physiological aspects across various weather conditions.
- ✓ Organized and trained green enterprises as tree seed suppliers, linking them to markets to improve livelihoods.
- ✓ Established *Acacia senegal* and *Juniperus procera* seed orchards in high-risk extinction areas.

3. Forest Resource Assessment and Market Support

- ✓ Conducted forest inventories with a sample intensity of 2-5% using systematic sampling methods.

- ✓ Utilized GIS software to generate sample plots, enhancing work quality and supporting plywood factories, lumber production, and market needs.

4. Stakeholder Engagement and Partnership Building

- ✓ Developed and maintained active working relationships with government authorities, donors, partner agencies, and local communities.
- ✓ Foster collaborations with the private sector, cooperatives, and government agencies to created sustainable market opportunities.
- ✓ Ensured responsible forest management and conservation through multi-sector partnerships and strategic initiatives.

3.4 Employer: As at the Safety-Net Program (Bilateral Organization)

Position: Livelihood and Natural Resource coordinator

Supporting: Sub-districts-Coordination-14 and 556 Beneficiaries

Experience: From September 07, 2007 up-to September 30, 2011

Key areas of accountability and accomplishments

1. Program Coordination and Implementation

- ✓ Led coordination efforts in the Productive Safety Net Program (PSNP), ensuring adherence to national guidelines, protocols, and regulations to address food insecurity.
- ✓ Served as the focal person for the bilateral Austrian Development Program, facilitating program activities and mobilizing communities for infrastructure development, including a 5-kilometer road network connecting Sub-district to District.

2. Forestry and Seed Management

- ✓ Developed comprehensive documentation for tree seed collection, storage, and distribution processes.
- ✓ Designed and delivered training materials covering nursery management, seedling production, tree planting techniques, and post-planting maintenance.

3. Livelihood and Community Development

- ✓ Implemented livelihood improvement initiatives, including small animal remnant and artificial insemination programs to enhance cattle genetics.
- ✓ Introduced and distributed energy-saving cook-stoves to promote sustainable energy use and reduce environmental impact.
- ✓ Oversaw the construction of farmer training centers equipped with modern infrastructure, integrating plasma screens, projectors, and experience-sharing platforms for effective knowledge transfer.

4. EDUCATION

Regarding to my educational background I have

4.1 **Level:** Master of Science (MSCs) in Geo-information

Duration: September 10, 2020 to June 30, 2023, and

Award: July 20, 2023 from Bahir-Dar University, City: Bahir-dar, Ethiopia

4.2 **Level:** Bachelor degree on Forestry (BSc)

Duration: from September, 9, 2002 to June 30, 2006 and

Award: July 8, 2006 from Hawassa University, City: Awassa, Ethiopia

5. TECHNICAL AND FUNCTIONAL SKILLS

- ✓ Skilled in digital tools including GIS/QGIS, Post-GIS, Power BI, and web technologies.
- ✓ Managing Remote sensing dataset within desktop environment (eCognition, ENVI, ERDAS, and QGIS), and cloud platform forums (Google Earth Engine, Microsoft Planetary computer)
- ✓ Experience in programming and scripting languages commonly used, such as JavaScript and Python and
- ✓ Proficiency in using version control systems (e.g., Git) to shared repositories like GitHub or GitLab.
- ✓ Strong command of English and Amharic with excellent written and verbal communication skills.

6. CERTIFICATES AND TRAINING ON:

6.1 Data Analysis Fundamental by UDACITY

(www.udacity.com/certificate/e/cd4f272e-69ce-11ef-92c3-7bb8a975d1cc)

- ✓ Certified in Data Analysis Fundamentals, with expertise in statistical methods and data interpretation.

6.2 Forest activity Data Generations and Result Based Payments by Hawassa University

From September 14 to September 23, 2023 by Cooperation of Hawassa University

- ✓ This accreditation demonstrates my proficiency in the most recent guidelines and best practices for addressing Remote sensing data analysis for activity data generation and forest related greenhouse gas inventory for result based payments.

6.3 Project Management from November 26 to November 30, 2020: on by Cooperation

UNDP and Norwegian government

- ✓ Result based project management and Payment for Ecosystem Service Valuation
- ✓ Product value chain development, forest-based value chain analysis, and implementation

6.4 Land use plan and management from August 26 to September 04, 2019 BY

Cooperation of Hessen Forest, Germany government

- ✓ It is crucial for the management of forest using Participatory land use plan for forest restoration

7. MAJOR ACHIEVEMENTS DURING MY CAREER

- ❖ Assessing and valuing carbon stocks across land use changes are crucial for effective climate change mitigation. My research conducted at Blue Nile Park, by 2023. So,
- ❖ Using the Carbon InVEST model and QGIS, the study mapped, quantified, and predicted carbon stock potential across different land use/land cover (LULC) types. The study highlights that land use changes significantly impact carbon stock values, emphasizing the need for carbon trade mechanisms to sustain the park's ecosystem.
(<http://ir.bdu.edu.et/handle/123456789/15757>)
- ❖ Since 2017, I have led the establishment of new tree plantations and facilitated the assisted natural regeneration of approximately 349,400 hectares. This work, carried out across selected woredas under the REDD+ Program, incorporated advanced geospatial tools to enhance biodiversity, restore climate balance, and promote sustainable forest management and climate change mitigation.
- ❖ I actively contributed to establishing and executing **National** Forest reference levels (FRL) of 2017 as part of MRV that ratified to **IPCCC**, significantly impacting social and environmental aspects
- ❖ In 2013 established the region's first Tree Seed Center, developing guidelines and roadmaps for data quality assurance. And identified 75 tree seed sources and green enterprises across the region, providing quality-assured seeds to development organizations.

8. REFERENCE

1. Mr. Sintayehu Derese (Regional REDD+ Program Coordinator)
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2. Dr. Biresaw Mahitot (Vice Head of Amhara Forest Enterprise & KFW Program coordinator), Mobil: +251 920878587, E-mail: biresawmt@gmail.com
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